📋 Contractors SOP & Best Practices for Trello Workflow v2

🔑 Card Titles & Emojis

To maintain AI readability and visual consistency across all boards:

- **Keep Titles Short:** Card titles must be concise — **One line only**. Longer titles interfere with automated tools that track and analyse activity 24/7.
- **AI Monitoring:** Titles and formatting are monitored **24/7** by AI tools for workflow integration. Incorrect formatting may disrupt automation.
- **Clarity First:** Every Trello card must have a **clear, correctly capitalised title**.
  Use clear, descriptive wording — avoid filler phrases or long explanations in the title.
- **Admins do not provide card titles** → Contractors must create and manage their own.
- **Follow-Up:** Any updates or corrections should be logged under the relevant card in the 🗞️ **Updates** list.

📝 Description Section Usage

- All comments, notes, and updates must be added in the **Description** section of the card.
- ❌ Do not scatter updates in multiple areas.
- ✅ Keep everything in one place for clarity and easy reference.

🕵️ Activity Section Usage

- The **Activity section** shows a timeline of all recent updates across multiple cards.
- Contractors must check the Activity section **at the start and end of each work session**.

- **Benefits:**
    - ✅ Saves time when working on many cards.
    - ✅ Ensures no update is missed.
    - ✅ Provides a transparent record of work.
- 📖 Learn more: Trello Board Menu & Activity Section

🔐 Access & Onboarding

- All contractors must send their Trello username.
- Admins will then share the appropriate Trello board.
- Contractors are assigned cards/titles to complete based on:
    - This SOP
    - Job description
    - Previous discussions/agreements
- Contractors are expected to work directly inside Trello and maintain a professional, presentable board.

🚫 Member & Board Permissions

- **Only admins** may add or remove members from cards and boards.
- Contractors must not invite people or adjust permissions.
- ✅ Team members **are responsible** for moving their cards, updating descriptions, and managing their boards.
- If additional access is needed → tag an admin.

⏰ Deadlines & Due Dates

- **Only admins** may set or edit deadlines.
- Contractors must not add, change, or remove due dates.
- ✅ Team members manage card updates but deadline control remains with admins.

👨‍🦱 Team Identity

- Each team member must upload a clear profile photo in Trello.
- A professional or neutral image is preferred.

🎯 Board Presentation Standards

- Boards must be **immaculate and presentable at all times**.
- A clean board reflects professionalism and affects how much work you are assigned.

🎨 Visual Branding & Backgrounds

- **Only admins** may change board backgrounds, colors, or branding.
- Contractors must not modify these settings.
- Branding consistency is part of our professional identity.

🛠️ Contractor Trello Requirements

- Contractors must set up and manage Trello boards independently.
- Boards must always be **clear, precise, and presentable**.

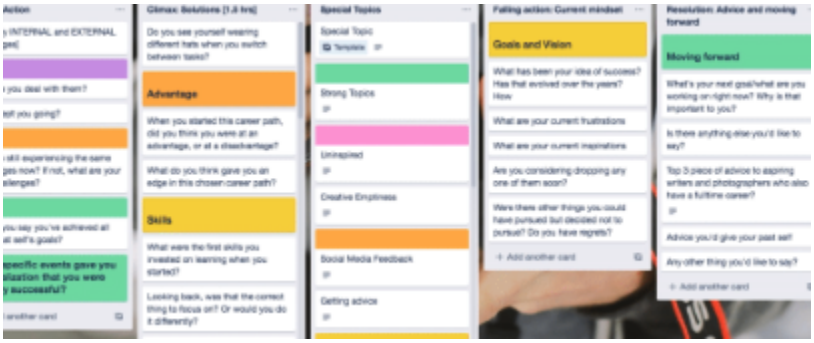
- Trello boards serve both **task management** and **professional project presentations**.
- The quality of your board reflects your **professional skills and attention to detail**.
- Trello is straightforward and ensures a **streamlined process**, enabling more projects to move forward efficiently.

🖼️ **Card Media / Labelling & References (Final Updated)**

- Use **full URLs only** (❌ no shortened or hidden links).
- **Videos and screenshots** are required when demonstrating progress, reporting issues, or showing completed work.
- **Do not use card covers** — covers interfere with our AI agents and disrupt visual uniformity.
- **Label cards appropriately** using the approved internal labelling system (no colour overlaps or personal labels unless pre-approved).
- ⚙️ **System Labels (Reserved for AI):**
    - 🟩 **Green**
    - 🟨 **Yellow**
    - 🟧 **Orange**
    - 🟥 **Red**

      These colours are reserved for internal AI processing — **do not use them** under any circumstances.
- ✅ You may create your own labels if required; however, when doing so:
    - Post a card in the **Resources** 🌏 **list** explaining your label choices and reasoning.
    - Avoid duplicating reserved system colours.

- Maintain logical consistency across your assigned boards.
- Do not use Trello card covers (as seen below) as it causes conflict with our AI Agent



📦 Bulk Fixes & Notifications

- When bulk updates are completed:
  - Move updated cards into the Review column.
  - Notify once (on a single card).
- ❌ Do not tag for every card.
- ✅ One clear notification is enough.

💬 Communication Protocol

💬 Trello Tagging & Notifications

To ensure communication is received promptly:

- Tag Correctly: Always tag team members via the Trello web app, not by replying through email notifications. We work directly in Trello.

- No Email Sync: Replies sent via email do not trigger desktop notifications for the recipient.
- Preferred Method: All correspondence and updates must occur directly within Trello.
- If Missed: Simply re-tag the person in the card comment using `@username` within the web app.
- Rationale: This keeps discussions centralised, trackable, and visible to all project members.
- Priority: The cards are listed by **priority** as mentioned in the **General consideration card and Resources list.**

🗂️ Message Placement

- All messages must be posted in the **correct cards**.
- ❌ The team will **not respond** if messages are posted incorrectly.
- ⚠ Excessive pings may push your query to the bottom of the queue..
- Platforms like **Upwork/Fiverr etc are for payments only**.
- ❌ Do not duplicate messages across Trello and Upwork/Fiverr.
- ✅ One notification is enough—we will see it in the system.

📅 **Updates & ETAs**

- Each message must include your **next update timeline or ETA**.
- Example: *"Next update tomorrow by 6pm."*

💬 **Relevant Updates Only**

- Only discuss updates on **relevant boards and cards**.
- ❌ Do not post comments on unrelated cards.

Messaging Frequency

- Send **one message per day per project** in the respective cards.
- Tag team members **once per day, at the end of your work session**.
- ❌ Do not repeatedly tag — it's disruptive and unnecessary.

Response Times

- Expect **one update per day on average**.
- ❌ Messaging multiple times does not speed up replies.

- Messages are queued and processed in our **CRM / CWM / SRM / ERP / BI / Analytics / PLM system**.

🛠️ **Tools & Resources**

- **AI Tools** (ChatGPT, etc.)
- **Formatting Tools**: Capitalization Tool
- **Media Tools**: Lightshot / Gyazo / Loom / Canva
- **File Sharing**: Google Drive / Docs
- **Project Management**: Trello Core system for all tasks, updates, and project tracking.

⚡ *Note: Contractors are responsible for learning and using these tools correctly. Mastery of Trello, GPT/AI tools, and presentation standards is considered part of your professional skills.*

✅ **Card Completion Policy**

- Please avoid manually marking cards as complete or incomplete in Trello.

- This process is automated and monitored by our AI Agent and Mani to maintain accurate tracking and system consistency.

1️⃣ Board Maintenance

- Update the Trello board with all recent progress

💎 Summary

📌 **Card Titles**: Clear + **emoji** + **capitalised**.

📝 **Comments**: Always in **Description**.

🔐 **Access**: Contractors must share Trello username → **admins will add them**.

🧑‍💼 **Team Identity**: Upload a **professional profile photo** in Trello.

🎯 **Board Presentation**: Keep board **immaculate & professional**.

🛠️ **Contractor Requirement**: Must **set up/manage Trello boards** independently.

🖼️ **Media**: Each card includes an **image**. Use **full URLs**. Add **videos/screenshots** when needed.

📦 **Bulk Fixes**: Notify **once only**, not per card.

💬 **Communication**: Use **Trello only**. One message = enough.

🔔 **Tagging**: **Only once per day**, at end of session.

⏳ **Responses**: Follow system queue (**avg. 1 per day**).

⚡ **Tools**: Use **AI tools, Grammarly, capitalization tools, screenshots, and Trello utilities**.

❓ FAQs

Q1: What if I finish tasks early?

A1: Move the card to the correct column (e.g., *Review* or *Done*) and update the description. Only tag once at the end of your session.

Q2: Can I send files via Upwork/Fiverr?

A2: No. Only payments are handled on Upwork/Fiverr. All deliverables and communication must stay in Trello.

Q3: What if my task doesn't need an image or video?

A3: At least one relevant media item (image, screenshot, or supporting graphic) is required for every card. For purely text-based work, attach a screenshot of your document or progress.

Q4: What happens if I miss a deadline?

A4: Notify us via Trello.

Q5: Why can't I tag multiple times per day?

A5: Multiple tags cause notification overload. Tag once at the end of your session; we review everything in structured queues daily.

Q6: How often will I get feedback?

A6: On average, once per day. Urgent issues will be flagged, but routine tasks follow the normal review cycle.

Q7: How will important updates be handled if they come through multiple channels?

A7: This is why we use Trello as the single source of truth. All updates, deliverables, and communication must flow through Trello to avoid missed or duplicated information.

Q8: Why is this workflow required?

A8: It ensures clarity, accountability, and efficiency. This system prevents miscommunication, missed updates, and keeps project management reliable and structured.

Q9: How much work is typically included in a single milestone?

A9: There's no fixed measure — each task is unique. Work is assigned as needed, and there is always work available. Payment terms follow the contract on Upwork/Fiverr.

Q10: When do you release milestone payments?

A10: Payments are released only after the task is checked and completed.

Q11: What's the best way to plan and pace my work for milestone completion?

A11: Follow Trello — all tasks are listed in order of priority. Use the board as your guide for planning and pacing.